

Figure 9.33 Kasuti Embroidery

9.5.6 Kashmiri Embroidery (Kashida)

Region

Kashida is embroidery originated from Kashmir. It is practiced by menfolk of the region. The elaborate needlework is inspired by the charming natural surroundings of Kashmir.

Technique

The base material for Kashida is cotton. Wool or silk fabric in a variety of colours like white, blue, yellow, purple, red, green and black are also used. The embroidery threads used are wool, silk or cotton depending on the product to be embroidered. The main stitches employed for Kashida are darning stitch, stem stitch, satin stitch and chain stitch.

Motifs

The motifs used in Kashida depict the natural elements which include the rich flora and fauna of the region of Kashmir. Typical motifs are birds, flowers, butterflies, maple leaves, almonds, cherries, grapes and plums. A popular motif seen on embroidered shawl is the cypress cone.

Style of Embroidery

There are three styles of embroidery followed in Kashmir; (i) Sozni is intricate embroidery that uses stitches like a fly stitch, stem stitch and darning stitch. (ii) aari style, also called Zalakdozi employs hook or aari to fill-in motifs with chain stitch. (iii) Kashmiri couching, zarithread is laid on the fabric along a pattern and is held in place with another thread

End Use

Kashmiri embroidery is primarily done on shawls and regional garments like Phiran. Chain stitch embroidery is made on woollen floor rugs called Gabbas and Namdas. Nowadays, Kashida is also used to enhance household items like bed covers, cushion covers, lampshades, bags and other accessories.



Figure 9.34 Kashidha Embroidery

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